

points. It performed brilliantly in all the tests, except in the dark screen test. For the second place there was a tie between Benq 99SL and Sony CPD-G420 with a score of 18.5 points each.

Lastly, in the 21- and 22-inch category, Sony CPD-G520 showed an exceptionally brilliant performance in all tests. We could observe no flicker and the Dark Screen was perfect with no reflection of background objects. This indicates that



Sony CPD-G520 (21-inch)

one will experience less eyestrain while working with this monitor.

Viewsonic P220F came second. It lost out only because of its average performance in the Dark Screen test where we could see white objects even at a distance of 2 feet. Philips 201B's performance was below average and it performed particularly badly in the Flicker test and the Dark Screen test—the background objects were clearly visible.

Making a choice

This comparison test proved to be a close and well fought battle between top brands. One remarkable fact that we observed was that as we moved up the categories, there was a steady rise in the points scored. There was a definite improvement in sharpness and resolution along with better colour reproduction. This is a clear indicator of how things improve as you move to bigger monitors.

15-inch monitors: The monitor to get the highest overall score was the **Viewsonic E53** (61.8 per cent). We were impressed by this monitor's ability to give a flicker-free display at high resolution, while preserving image quality. This one undoubtedly deserves the Best Performance award.

Its nearest competitor was the **Proview PA-566** which scored 60.9 per cent. It takes our Best Value award for 15-inch monitors. Its performance was almost as good as that of the Viewsonic E53, and it came at an unbeatable cost of only Rs 5,600.

17-inch monitors: This category saw the maximum number of monitors—we received 18 monitors from 11 different brands.

As expected, the results were much better than what we saw in the 15-inch monitors—the overall score went as high as 75.5 per cent here. The winner of the Best Performance award in this category was the **Viewsonic G73f**—this flat monitor managed to just scrape ahead of the Samsung SyncMaster 753s. It delivers a crisp and crystal clear display but as always with the best performers, it demands a hefty premium. This monitor is available for Rs 18,750, which makes it the most expensive monitor in its category.

The **Samsung SyncMaster 753s** takes the Best Value crown without too much effort. Performance wise it was very close to the Viewsonic G73f, but the G73f simply cannot match its price. You can have this wonderful monitor for just Rs 10,000!

19-inch monitors: The count for this category stood at six and the highest overall score crept up to 79.3 per cent.

Sony CPD-G420 emerged the Best Performance winner, thrilling us with its amazing display abilities. It will truly delight any design or multimedia pro-

fessional. It is simply the best when it comes to image quality, geometric precision or colour reproduction. But hold your breath—it will put you back by Rs 52,000, which is at least 30 per cent more expensive than other monitors in this category.

The Best Value award goes to **Compaq MV940**. Purely on performance it was just 1.23 per cent behind the Sony CPD-G420 scoring 78 per cent. But the price factor is what gives it the edge—just Rs 21,736.



Compaq MV940 (19-inch)

21- and 22-inch monitors: We received seven monitors representing six brands. Two of these were 22-inch monitors, which we clubbed with the 21-inchers as they had a viewable area of 20 inch as against 19.8 inch for most 21-inch monitors. We witnessed one of the toughest fights in this category—the Sony CPD-G520, Viewsonic G810 and the Viewsonic P220F were equally brilliant, each scoring an overall 81 per cent.

Hence, to select a best performance winner, we looked at the feature list of each monitor. The **Sony CPD-G520** was easily the winner. This monitor uses the Aperture Grille technology, has a dot pitch of 0.24 mm and can reach a maximum resolution of 2048x1536 at 60 Hz. Of course, it costs a bomb! It is available for Rs 83,200.

Selecting the **Viewsonic G810** as the Best Value winner was easy. It scored equal to the Sony CPD-G520, but didn't get the Best performance award on account of the tie.

But when one considers its price—just Rs 45,000—there can be no doubt about the value it offers. Price conscious buyers who wouldn't like to compromise on quality will find this their best companion for a long time to come.

Decision Maker			
	Office Productivity	Home and Internet	Graphics and Design Professionals
You need	A display that generates crisp text and is easy on the eye	A display that is suitable for video and gaming and fits your budget	A large display with a high resolution support and accurate colour reproduction
Look for	A 15-inch monitor	A 15- or 17-inch monitor	A 19-, 21- or 22-inch monitor
The models	Krypton 500LR, Proview PA-566	Acer V551-M, Samsung SyncMaster 753s, or Viewsonic G73f	Sony CPD-G420, Compaq MV940, Samsung SyncMaster 1100p Plus, Sony CPD-G520, or Viewsonic G810
Price range	Up to Rs 8,000	Up to Rs 12,000	Rs 20,000 and above